Project Design Phase
Problem - Solution Fit Template

Date	31 January 2025
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Problem - Solution Fit:

The problem-solution fit is achieved when you have found a problem that your customer has and can show that your solution solves it. It helps you understand your customers' situation, spot the behaviors that drive their problem, and check that the solution matches what they need before the team builds it.
Purpose: Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers. Succeed faster by understanding existing situations and behavior. Increase the sense of urgency and align with customers' needs. Improve adoption by designing for how people already work.
Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer.

Template

1. Customer segment(s)

- New employees and existing staff who need a standard laptop
- Managers who approve laptop requests for their teams
- IT procurement coordinators who fulfil the orders

2. Jobs-to-be-done / problems

Jobs to be done

- Get an approved laptop quickly and see its status
- Approve requests without delay
- Fulfil orders accurately

Problems

- Manual approvals, no status visibility, repeated data entry

3. Triggers to act

- A new hire is about to join
- A laptop reaches its refresh cycle
- A device is lost, damaged or too slow
- A team grows and needs more devices

4. Emotions: before / after

Before

- Anxious, frustrated, unsure whether the request is moving

After

- Relieved, confident, in control with clear status and a laptop on time

5. Available solutions

- Email requests and spreadsheets: familiar but slow and error-prone
- Generic catalog with manual approvals: still needs chasing
- Manual stock checks and purchase orders: time-consuming for IT

6. Customer constraints

- Budget limits per cost center
- Approval and security policies
- Limited stock and vendor lead times
- Limited IT staff time for routine tasks

7. Behaviour

- Employees email IT or their manager to ask for status
- Managers delay approvals when busy or when details are missing
- Coordinators check inventory and create orders by hand

Related behaviour

- Raising follow-up tickets and asking colleagues for help

8. Channels of behaviour

Online

- Employee portal and service catalog
- Email and mobile approvals

Offline

- Calls and in-person follow-ups with IT or the manager

9. Problem root cause

- The request depends on manual hand-offs between people and systems
- There are no automated rules for standard requests
- There is no single view of request status

10. Your solution

- One standard laptop catalog item in ServiceNow
- Flow Designer automates approval, stock check, purchase order and asset record
- Automatic notifications and a status view for the employee
- Dashboard of turnaround time and savings

Fit check: each part of the solution answers a root cause. Automated rules replace manual hand-offs, notifications replace status chasing, and a single catalog item replaces scattered email requests.

Screenshots

Screenshots of the ServiceNow prototype showing parts of the proposed solution in use: one catalog item, a visible request status and a recorded approval.

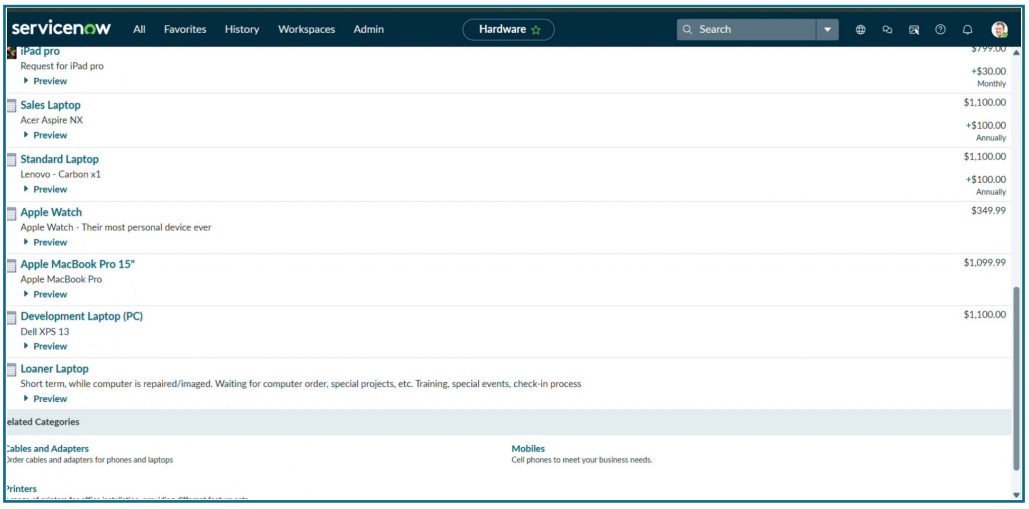


Figure 1: Standard Laptop offered as one catalog item under Hardware

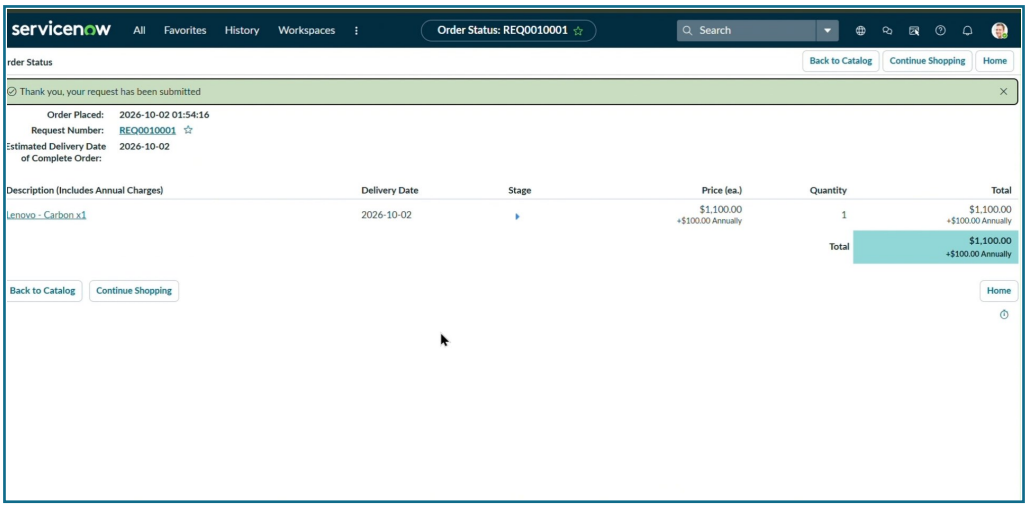


Figure 2: Order Status page confirming request REQ0010001 was submitted

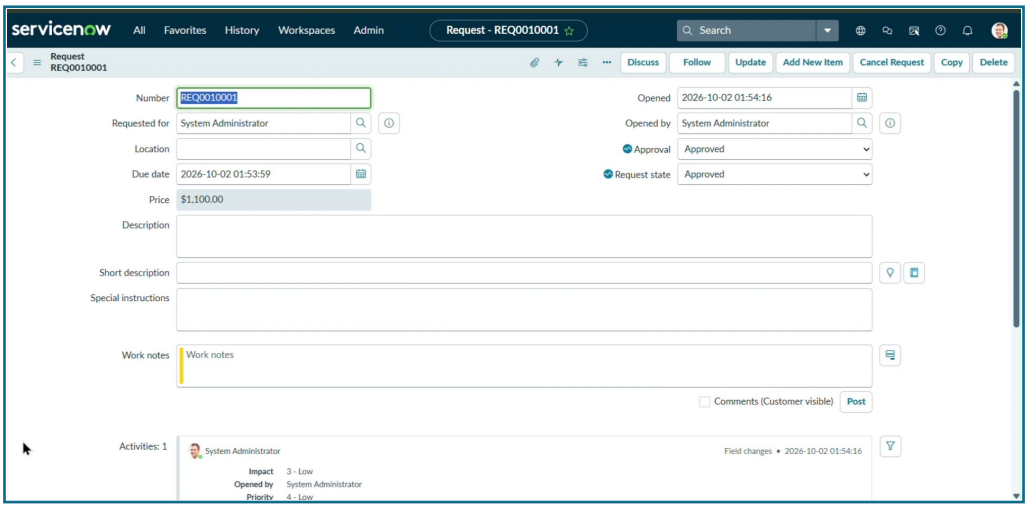


Figure 3: Request REQ0010001 with Approval and Request state Approved